

Tried & tested



TABLET SUTRA

Tablets came a long way in 2011, from near-irrelevance to considerable utility. We compared 17 tablets to find out which would fit your needs and budget best.

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Tablets have come a long way since the iPad released back in 2010, its competitors scrambling to release half-baked products in a mad rush to make a (largely unsuccessful) mark. Consumers did sit up and take notice of tablets as

secondary computing devices along with a desktop or laptop PC, but not many were dazzled by their potential or value. Plus a lot of early tablets were almost exclusively expensive, so a large base of consumers didn't spare much thought of buying one. Even in the beginning of 2011, no one really bothered about them tablets. We nodded at their increasing presence in elec-

tronic stores and malls, spent a few seconds wondering where they would fit in between the smartphone and the laptop in our lives and moved on. But as is usual in technology, tablets eventually hogged the limelight and became one of the fastest growing product segments in 2011. They have become the hottest gadgets around. Everyone wants one, partly because of better specs and multi-tasking between media, web browsing, office-specific tasks and a bit of gaming, and dropping prices. All this in a form factor that's much more convenient to carry around than a laptop or a netbook. Consumers, even though a small demographic at the moment, have found a way to integrate it in their lives, between the smartphone and the laptop. And these devices are available across multiple price points – critically, the sub ₹15k price bracket.

For this edition of the tablet test, we are testing 17 tablets